



That's fair

Finland's fines are based on income, earning one Nokia executive a \$103,000 speeding ticket



Life and death

A study conducted in the U.S. found that you're about 14% more likely to die on your birthday than on any other.

Bazaar

Honor 6 Plus

If only they were braver

There's an old saying, "Imitation is the sincerest form of flattery."

If that is true, then the Honor 6 Plus sure does flatter a lot of the competition, with Sony and Apple being the principles. The design takes subtle hints from Sony, while the UI draws from Apple. Amidst all that though, the Honor 6 Plus still manages to maintain its own distinctive personality.

The phone has a glass back and an ever so slightly rounded bottom. If it wasn't for the metal bands on the side, this would have been called a Sony Xperia Z3 rip-off. But, if you can take an existing design and make it better aesthetically, then it's not a rip-off. The metal edges on the side make for a really nice and premium feeling smartphone, especially when coupled with the glass back.

At 165 grams, it is a bit on the heavy side, but in my opinion that adds a certain heft to the device. It feels really sturdy and Huawei's promise of bulletproof glass bolsters that even more.

It's a flagship device and one that has a 5.5-inch display, which means a 1080p panel is obvious, especially if you consider the price. A pixel density of 401 ppi makes the display really sharp but it still seems to be lacking when viewed from the sides. They're enough to watch videos alone, but at the price Honor 6 Plus is asking, I daresay it could have been better.

My first complaint about the Honor 6 Plus is the user interface. While EMUI runs smooth and lag free, it doesn't seem to be well thought out. The company has added its own version of Apple's Spotlight search and Control Center, but none of them really make any difference. Honor's version of Spotlight isn't anywhere close to being as useful as Apple's. It is essentially just another Google bar in your phone.

The Control Center like buttons (on the lock screen) on the other hand are cumbersome. A swipe anywhere on the bottom fourth of the screen brings up the Control Center. In a phablet, this isn't a good thing to do. With the swipe to unlock setting, I often



Interactive review

Price ₹26,499

ended up bringing up this panel when I didn't want to. In this case, it is simply an Apple rip-off.

I find the Kirin 925 processor to be an absolute treat to work with, but if only the pricing was lower. The performance is at par with the Nexus 5, which quickly drops to the Moto X (1st Gen) level when you use the power saving mode. To put it simply, on the power saving mode, lags and stutters will creep in, especially on high-end games.

In benchmarks, the device comes out to be quite competitive, and as long as you keep it off the power saving mode, you'll see no drop in terms of performance.

Though you will have to give up on Huawei's over-one-day battery life claim.

Also, despite what Huawei says about the Kirin 925's temperature controls, the Honor 6 Plus does tend to heat up. That said, it cools down fast enough as well.

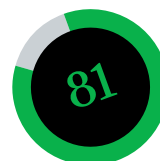
The area where the Honor 6 Plus really redeems itself is the dual-8 MP camera on the back. This allows more light to be taken in and is also how the Honor 6 Plus allows for the Wide Aperture mode. It clicks amazing pictures, especially bokeh shots, and is the best camera in the sub-30k range.

Unlike the HTC One M8, which also has dual cameras on the back, this combination allows you to tilt shift the focus points later on.

The 3600 mAh battery on the Honor 6 Plus is heavily dependent on the power saving modes and aggressive throttling of the CPU. The Smart Power saving mode almost never allows the CPU to go beyond 800 MHz, while the Ultra Power Saving mode is reminiscent of Samsung's feature by the same name. Without these modes, your battery won't last for the whole day.

The Honor 6 Plus is easily the most balanced smartphone that I've reviewed in a long time. If a good camera is what you're looking for, then go for it. But if you want uncompromising performance and a better battery life, then the OnePlus One is a better choice.

Prasid Banerjee



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Specifications

Display: 5.5-inch 1080p; **Processor:** HiSilicon Kirin 925 octa-core; **Operating System:** Android 4.4.2 with EMUI 3.0; **Camera:** dual-8 MP rear, 8 MP front; **Battery:** 3600 mAh

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